NOT MEASUREMENT SENSITIVE

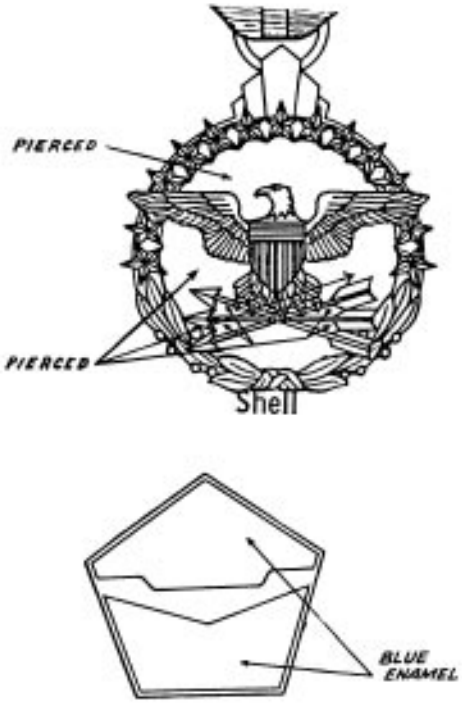
MIL-DTL-3943/72D
1 May 1997
SUPERSEDING
MIL-D-3943/72C
24 June 1994

DETAIL SPECIFICATION SHEET

DECORATION, DEFENSE DISTINGUISHED SERVICE MEDAL

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

The requirements for acquiring the product described herein shall consist of this specification sheet and the issue of MIL-DTL-3943 listed in that issue of the Department of Defense Index of Specifications and Standards (DoDISS) specified in the solicitation.



MATERIAL:
SHELL (Eagle and Wreath): Red Brass
PENTAGON INSERT: Gilding Metal

DASH NO.
-1: Regular Size
-2: Miniature Size

AMSC N/A FSC 8455

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A. Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-16T23:18Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

FINISH:
  OBVERSE:
   SHELL: Gold Plated, Rose Gold Plated, Relieved, Polished Highlights.
   INSERT: Hard Enameled, Gold Plated, Rose Gold Plated, Relieved, Matte Finish, Polished Highlights.

  REVERSE: Gold Plated, Rose Gold Plated, Relieved, Matte Finish, Polished Highlights.

DIMENSIONS:
   SHELL:
     HEIGHT (Overall):
         -1: 1-7/8 inches (4.76 cm) (REF)
         -2: 15/16 inch (2.38 cm) (REF)
     WIDTH (Overall):
         -1: 1-5/8 inches (4.13 cm) (REF)
         -2: 15/16 inch (2.38 cm) (REF)
     THICKNESS (At Eagle's Shield):
         -1: 0.135 inch ± 0.005 inch (0.343 cm ± 0.012 cm)
         -2: 0.090 inch ± 0.005 inch (0.229 cm ± 0.012 cm)

   INSERT:
     HEIGHT (Overall):
         -1: 1-3/16 inches (3.02 cm) (REF)
         -2: 19/32 inch (1.51 cm) (REF)
     WIDTH (Overall):
         -1: 1-1/4 inches (3.18 cm) (REF)
         -2: 5/8 inch (1.59 cm) (REF)
     THICKNESS (At Thickest Point):
         -1: 0.080 inch ± 0.005 inch (0.103 cm ± 0.012 cm)
         -2: 0.060 inch ± 0.005 inch (0.152 cm ± 0.012 cm)

   ASSEMBLED THICKNESS (At Eagle's Shield):
         -1: 0.215 inch ± 0.010 inch (0.546 cm ± 0.025 cm)
         -2: 0.150 inch ± 0.010 inch (0.381 cm ± 0.025 cm)

NOTES:
    1. The term (REF) refers to the measurements taken from the Government furnished hub or die.

    2. Enameled color shall be blue as indicated. The enamel color shall conform to the TIOH chip number 33 or the standard sample.

    3. Epoxy resin (stoning epoxy) may be used in lieu of hard enamel at the option of the manufacturer.

    4. Pierced areas shall be as indicated.

    5. The insert shall be soft soldered to the shell in the position shown.

    6. The lug shall be located on the vertical center line of the shell and shall be fabricated from 0.065 inch ± 0.003 inch (0.165 cm ± 0.008 cm) nominal diameter wire for Dash No. -1 and 0.040 inch ± 0.003 inch (0.102 cm ± 0.008 cm) nominal diameter wire for Dash No. -2 with the same material and finish as the shell. The lug shall be a half circle hard soldered in the location shown with an outside diameter of 7/32 inch ± 1/64 inch (0.56 cm ± 0.04 cm) for Dash No. -1 and 5/32 inch ± 1/64 inch (0.40 cm ± 0.04 cm) for Dash No. -2.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-16T23:18Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

7. Decoration set shall consist of a regular size medal, a service ribbon and a lapel button all packaged in a presentation case conforming to MIL-DTL-14633, Type X, Style 8 with a Class 1 or 1A pad.

8. The ribbon for the pendant drape and service ribbon shall conform to MIL-DTL-11589/182.

9. The lapel button shall conform to MIL-DTL-11484/91.

CHANGES FROM PREVIOUS ISSUE: Marginal notations are not used in this revision to identify changes with respect to the previous issue due to the extent of the changes.

Custodians:
Army - IH

Preparing activity:
Army - IH

Review activities:
DLA - CT

(Project No. 8455-0887)

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-16T23:18Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.